

education environment. Anyone who loves to think, create, doodle and introspect ideally are better!”

That’s interesting, anyone who thinks, creates or doodles. So effectively, if you were a back-bencher in school and were always picked on for sketching in your notes, you might just have it in you to make it to one of the best design institutes in the world. But this just shows being the studious one alone doesn’t get you there. You’d need the right kind of attitude with aptitude to stand out of the crowd. According to Prof. Balaram, more stress is put on aptitude and attitude rather than academics. “We look for students with a creative bent of mind. The aspirant should also have a strong sense of aesthetics (form and colour) with a broad outlook. Divergence is most important for design and so is team work. We try to gauge all these qualities in the probable student by way of aptitude tests prior to admission. Before offering admission we also conduct a personal interview to confirm (as much as possible) he/she is genuinely talented.”

The road ahead

After graduating from design school, the obvious route is to design studios that most MNCs have set up. In fact, several Indian companies such as Onida, Videocon and TI Cycles are also setting up design studios in India



Image courtesy: ArchitectureWeek.com

This ultra modern house was designed by Charles and Ray Eames in the 1940s and is known as Case Study House #8